



IT Policy

Kevin Belanger
Systems Administrator

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Introduction

CPCS IT Systems Policy

Information technology systems at CPCS are constantly growing and transforming. This document describes current IT systems usage policy.

Purpose

This document describes the expectations, obligations, and responsibilities for all employees, associates and subcontractors using IT systems at CPCS.

This manual introduces all the IT systems used at CPCS. The manual outlines each of these systems and applications, and indicates the required proficiency levels. [\[1\]](#)

Staff are expected to become familiar with CPCS IT systems and applications, to use them effectively, and to provide input for their improvement. Knowledge and use of these systems is an important measure of individual performance.

Organization of this Document

This document provides usage policies on the current information systems at.

- Chapter 2 lists software applications used at CPCS and the expected proficiency for CPCS personnel.
- Chapters 3 and 4 describe standards, obligations, limitations, and responsibilities while using CPCS IT systems.

Document Conventions

N.B. (Nota Bene) This symbol is used to indicate important information.

WARNING This symbol indicates a warning. It is used to indicate situations where a loss of data or damage to hardware could result.

Data Entry: Courier font is used to indicate text information that is entered by the user.

<angle brackets> Angle brackets (*less than, greater than*) are used to indicate variable information that is entered by the user.

For example: <username> indicates that "Mary Smith" should enter her user name as: msmith leaving out the angle brackets.

Standard Software

Standard Software at CPCS

CPCS supports a set of commonly used software applications. Employees and associates are expected to be familiar with the set of standard applications listed in Table 2-1.

Table 2-1 – Software Used at CPCS		
Function	CPCS Standard	Required Level of Proficiency
Operating system	Microsoft Windows 10	High
	Microsoft Windows 11	
Word processing	Microsoft Word	High

Table 2-1 – Software Used at CPCS		
Function	CPCS Standard	Required Level of Proficiency
Spreadsheet	Microsoft Excel	High
Slide presentations	Microsoft PowerPoint	High
Scheduling	Microsoft Outlook	Functional
Project accounts	Deltek Vision	High
Email	Microsoft Outlook	High
Browser	Microsoft Edge	High
Project Collaboration and File Management	SharePoint	High
CV Database	SharePoint	High
Instant messaging,	Teams	High
Desktop Sharing	Teams	Functional
Point to point voice and video communications	Teams	Functional
Video Conferencing	Teams	Functional

Document Policies

Document Formats

Standard CPCS Document Formats

Proposals and Projects contain standard CPCS document formats which are to be followed at all times (client privilege notwithstanding). These formats may be found within newly created Proposal and Project Sites and Document Libraries in SharePoint.

It is important to use the latest formats available. Formats are published on an irregular basis. And can be found here: [Templates](#)

PDF

Microsoft Word from Office 365 is the current CPCS standard document editor, but clients often request the more efficient and portable document type of Adobe portable document format (PDF) for both documents and presentation files. PDF is the preferred format for rendering a document such that it is independent of application or operating system differences.

PDF Document Security

All CPCS documents that are to be submitted in PDF format must be password protected to allow for printing only (no edits). For documents after July 1, 2016, the standard password to be used for protecting PDFs is **1996CPCS10**. The standard password for documents prior to July 2016 is **dvaughan**.

Document Naming Conventions

When an Opportunity is created in Vision, a five digit number is automatically generated. This number is used throughout to identify SharePoint Sites, Document Libraries, Folders, and documents.

N.B. All names are to be kept as short as practically possible.

WARNING Long names may result in SharePoint errors. Microsoft imposes a 260 character limit on SharePoint URLs. Long names can quickly cause this limit to be exceeded.

Appendix B describes SharePoint naming restrictions. Certain special characters etc. are not allowed within SharePoint. These restrictions must be followed.

In addition to the rules above, the following sections describe the naming policies for items in the Prequals, Proposals, and Projects sites.

Client Correspondence

The following naming convention should be used for all correspondence sent to Clients.

<Client> <Letter Date> <Subject>

E.g. MTW 2016 07 11 Contract negotiations.docx

Document Versions

SharePoint has a document version history mechanism. Staff are expected to use the document versioning rather than changing the name of a file and saving a copy to create a new version.

Staff are expected to check out the document before making changes. When the document is ready to be checked back in, staff are expected to add a check-in comment to document the changes made.

Two simple rules:

1. Do not create copies of documents
2. Use SharePoint versioning history.

Cleanup

Computer and Network Use

Computer Policy

General Computer Policy

Core Staff employees are provided with a Lenovo laptop computer to be used on the road and at CPCS offices. IT support will not be provided for personal computers or other devices. CPCS provides a "relatively" up-to-date portable computer, based on user needs. Any divergence from being assigned a system other than a standard

issue Lenovo will be based on demonstrative need. Appropriate RAM, hard drive and accessories, including sound, etc. are provided. The laptop model issued to a staff member is based on the system requirements communicated to IT by the relevant VP and the availability of units at the time. Any requests to exchange the computer issued to a staff member with another model must be directed through the relevant VP or GD, with the decision then to be determined upon consultation between IT and management.

N.B.: CPCS does not provide systems with non-QWERTY keyboard layouts.

When a computer is deemed to be of no further use to CPCS, employees are encouraged to arrange for the sale of their laptop to local sub-contract staff in the countries where we are working. The resale price will be determined by management.

Employees are provided with a headset for Teams communications.

All employees are required to comply with the Laptop Security Policy.

Laptop Security Policy

Unless otherwise required, CPCS consulting staff are provided with company laptops for work-related use. Staff are required to sign a Laptop Loan Form upon receiving the laptop.

Staff are free to transport their company-issued laptop with them in order to complete work outside of the office or while traveling. However, removing your laptop from the office environment presents significant risks to the security of the unit through theft or damage. The following policy is meant to address this concern by outlining the responsibilities of staff as well as appropriate practices to abide by when transporting laptops outside of the office.

Security

Computer theft is prevalent. Laptops are a main target because of their relatively small size and the fact they are often used in public places.

When removing a laptop from the office environment, users agree to:

- Never allow anyone else to use or borrow the laptop.
- Never leave the laptop unattended.
- Never check the laptop as luggage while travelling. An exception to this will be when a staff person is asked to transport extra laptops.
- Be cautious with leaving bags at your feet or out of reach in train stations and airports. There have been cases where many children take bags and run off in different directions.
- Keep cars locked and laptops out of sight.
- Contact CPCS and the appropriate police authorities immediately to report a lost or stolen laptop.
- Participate in any investigation surrounding the loss, damage, or theft of the laptop, whether it is conducted by CPCS or the police.
- To the greatest extent possible, work from files stored on SharePoint. Lost data files cannot be restored by the IT department.

Should staff ignore these precautions resulting in the theft of CPCS laptops, they may be held fully or partially responsible for the replacement cost.

Maintenance

It is the responsibility of the user to ensure that the laptop loaned to him/her is adequately maintained during the loan period. Laptops are delicate machines and can break easily. As such, it is reasonable for damages to occur during regular use and transportation of laptops. These damages can include:

- Accidents, such as bumping or dropping the laptop.
- Spillage of food, drink, or other substances onto the unit.
- Damages caused by exposure to the elements.

Any physical damage to laptops must be reported to the IT department to determine the best course of action for repair. All staff are required participate in securing repairs on damaged laptops. This includes sending a laptop out for repair. The IT department will make all efforts to ensure repairs do not unreasonably limit

the work productivity of staff.

Staff will not be held responsible for the costs incurred in repairing laptops damaged during normal use. However, should damages be incurred as a result of poor treatment or misuse of the CPCS laptop, staff may be held fully or partially responsible for the costs of its repair.

Full Replacement of Damaged Laptops

Full replacement of damaged laptops will occur in limited situations as determined by Management.

Laptop Luggage

CPCS will reimburse staff up to CDN\$100.00 for a laptop carrying case.

Portable Device Policy

Portable tablets and phones may be used and connected to the CPCS Wi-Fi, with access restricted to the guest network if such is available. Usage of calendar and email functions is encouraged.

While reasonable efforts shall be made to troubleshoot issues with connecting personal devices to the CPCS Wi-Fi network, it is the end-user's responsibility to remediate any technical issues after seeking assistance from *IT*, should their device be unable to connect to the network with the provided login credentials.

Standard CPCS Issued IT Equipment

The following is the standard for IT equipment provided by CPCS.

If based in a CPCS Office, assuming minimum 2 days/week in office		If remo

<i>In office setup</i>	<i>Additional equipment for home</i>	
Laptop	Monitor	Docking
Monitor (2 for FIN employees)	Keyboard and Mouse	Monitor
Keyboard	Headphones	Keyboar
Mouse	Docking station	Mouse
Docking station	Extra USB-C or computer power supply	Headph
Headphones	HR will confirm with new hires which of the above items they would like for the at home setup. HR will then notify IT	



Computer Account Policy

New Accounts

A computer account and email account are created for each new employee, associate or sub-contractor as required. CPCS management has the exclusive authority to sanction the creation of a new account. IT support personnel act to create new accounts on this authority only. A username and initial password are issued.

Account Closure

When an employee leaves or is terminated for any reason, their associated computer and email account is disabled and archived. It is the responsibility of the employee's manager to specify the deposition of any files or email.

Password Policy

A username and password are issued when a new account is created. The password must be changed after the initial temporary password has been received by the employee.

Password rules:

Password complexity: A password must be at least twelve characters in length, with single spaces between characters counting towards the total

Shared Accounts

In general users are not allowed to share accounts. In certain exceptional circumstances where account sharing is necessary, management authorization is required.

In all other cases, users are expressly forbidden from using someone else's account.

Software and Data Policy

It is the responsibility of the employee to ensure that all corporate and project working files are saved on the server.

Employees may not install software on CPCS computers without the approval of the IT department, and the installation of software for purposes other than CPCS related duties is prohibited.

Installation of software that has been modified or cracked is prohibited.

Installation of pirated or illegally copied software is prohibited. It is illegal to install software licenced for a single computer on more than one computer.

Installing or running P2P software like BitTorrent for downloading movies, music, or software is prohibited.

Installing or running cryptocurrency mining software or scripts is prohibited.

Using Company Software on Home Computers

CPCS core employees are prohibited from installing or otherwise using software or other copyrighted material that has not been authorized by CPCS. CPCS owned

software shall not be authorized for use on any computer that is not owned by the company.

Commercial Software Packages for Associates and Subcontractors

Associates and subcontractors are expected to furnish their own licence for Microsoft Office Professional 2019 or newer, and to install and maintain updated anti-virus and security software.

To protect the integrity and confidentiality of CPCS' data, as well as the security of our systems, this policy will ensure that cloud and off-site services are not used for the storage, manipulation or exchange of company-related communications or company-owned data without the approval of CPCS management and the IT department.

Cloud and off-site services

This policy applies to all CPCS employees including Exclusive Associates and Associates

This policy pertains to all external cloud storage and computing services, as well as more traditional off-site storage/transfer/sharing services, such as FTP and SFTP.

Use of cloud computing and off-site services for work purposes must be formally authorized by management and the IT department. The IT department will certify that security, privacy and all other management requirements will be adequately addressed by the provider.

For any services that require users to agree to terms of service, such agreements must be reviewed and approved by the IT department.

Unless there is pre-approval, CPCS project data that is to be shared with externals shall be hosted solely on SharePoint, and the IT department shall –at a project team member's request- create site-specific security groups and user accounts, and make

the necessary permissions changes to a project site so as to allow external access to the data that is to be shared.

Personal cloud or off-site storage/transfer accounts may NOT be used for the storage, manipulation, or exchange of company-related communications or company-owned data.

Email Use Policy

The CPCS provides all employees and associates with a company email address. All CPCS employees and associates are required to use CPCS email for business purposes. It is important to use this email address when representing CPCS.

If desired, CPCS staff may also use the CPCS email address for personal use. If CPCS email is used for personal correspondence on a regular basis, it is recommended that CPCS email be the only address for both personal use and CPCS business. Using the CPCS email address exclusively will help to prevent accidental use of a personal email address for CPCS business. Using a personal email address for CPCS business is not permitted.

When and where necessary, CPCS webmail can be used as an alternative. This policy also applies to CPCS webmail.

Email Attachments

There is a 20 MByte limit to email attachments.

When sending email to a colleague with access to SharePoint, a link reference should be used rather than attaching the file itself. This greatly reduces mail server load and disk space requirements.

Unacceptable Email Use [2]

The following email usage is considered unacceptable:

- use of company communications systems to set up personal businesses or send chain letters
- forwarding of company confidential messages to external locations
- distributing, disseminating or storing images, text or materials that might be considered indecent, pornographic, obscene or illegal
- distributing, disseminating or storing images, text or materials that might be considered discriminatory, offensive or abusive, in that the context is a personal attack, sexist or racist, or might be considered as harassment
- accessing copyrighted information in a way that violates the copyright
- breaking into the company's or another organisation's system or unauthorised use of a password/mailbox
- broadcasting unsolicited personal views on social, political, religious or other non-business related matters
- transmitting unsolicited commercial or advertising material
- undertaking deliberate activities that waste staff effort or networked resources
- introducing any form of computer virus or malware into the corporate network

Monitoring and Sanctions

Refer to section 4.6.2.

Internet Acceptable Use Policy [\[3\]](#)

CPCS employees and subcontractors using CPCS network facilities must ensure that they:

- comply with current legislation
- use the internet in an acceptable way
- do not create unnecessary business risk to the company by their misuse of the internet

Unacceptable Internet Use

The following are examples of unacceptable use:

- visiting internet sites that contain obscene, hateful, pornographic or otherwise illegal material
- using the computer to perpetrate any form of fraud, or software, film or music piracy
- using the internet to send offensive or harassing material to other users
- downloading commercial software or any copyrighted materials belonging to third parties, unless this download is covered or permitted under a commercial agreement or other such licence
- hacking into unauthorised areas
- publishing defamatory or knowingly false material about CPCS, your colleagues or CPCS clients anywhere on the internet
- revealing CPCS proprietary information such as financial information, related client information, business plans, policies, internal CPCS discussions anywhere on the internet
- undertaking deliberate activities that waste staff effort or networked resources
- introducing any form of malicious software into the corporate network
- use of BitTorrent, Gnutella or similar P2P file sharing system clients on CPCS computers and networks

Company Owned Information Held on Third Party Websites

If you produce, collect or process business-related information in the course of your work, the information remains the property of CPCS. This includes business-related information stored on third-party websites.

Monitoring and Sanctions

CPCS accepts that the use of the internet is a valuable business tool. However, misuse of this facility can have a negative impact upon employee productivity and the reputation of the business.

In addition, all of the company's internet-related resources are provided for business purposes. Therefore, the company maintains the right to monitor the volume of internet and network traffic, together with the internet sites visited. The specific content of any transactions will not be monitored unless there is a suspicion of improper use.

Where it is believed that an employee has failed to comply with this policy, they will face appropriate consequences up to and including criminal charges where warranted.

Agreement

All company employees, contractors or temporary staff who have been granted the privilege to use CPCS's internet access are required to sign an agreement confirming their understanding and acceptance of this policy.

[1]Effective methods to measure proficiency levels are to be determined on a per-system and per-application basis, but the level of support required after initial familiarization with a given system is a proficiency indicator.

[2]Provided (edited and in part) by the UK National Archives under the worldwide [Open Government Licence](#).

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